SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-11-12 Thursday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply–Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

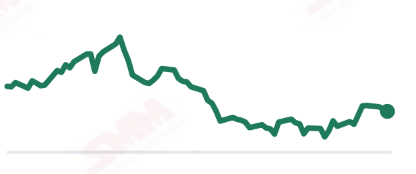
91.25

USD/dmt

FEFX26 · 2026-11 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-11-12 17:56:32 (UTC+8)

Quote time: 11-12 17:38:33 (UTC+8)


Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

671.0

yuan/mt

▼ -12.5 -1.83%

MTD avg **681.3**

As of Nov 12 · vs Nov 11

Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Nov 12

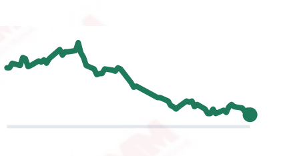
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

649

yuan/wmt

▼ -4 -0.61%

MTD avg **654**


Last 3 months

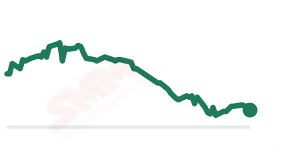
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

606

yuan/wmt

▼ -3 -0.49%

MTD avg **608**


Last 3 months

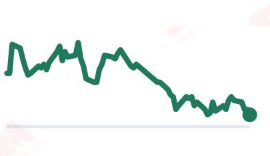
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

810

yuan/wmt

▼ -3 -0.37%

MTD avg **815**


Last 3 months

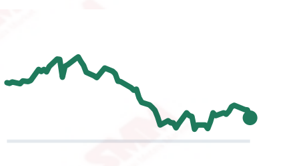
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

90.20

USD/dmt

▼ -1.10 -1.20%

MTD avg **91.19**


Last 3 months

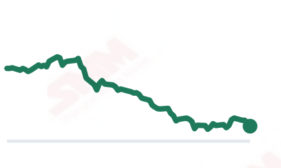
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.65

USD/dmt

▼ -0.45 -0.42%

MTD avg **107.18**


Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

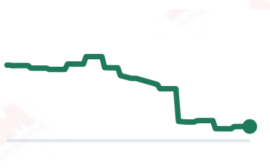
792.92

yuan/mt

— 0.00 0.00%

MTD avg **792.15**

As of Nov 12 · vs Nov 11


Last 3 months

Key View

Futures and spot soften as port stocks build; modest hot metal gains offer limited relief

Iron ore prices weakened broadly today. DCE most-traded closed at 671.0 yuan/mt, down 1.83% from the previous close, and all eight Qingdao spot products declined. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices fell 4, 3 and 3 yuan, respectively; seaborne 61% and 65% indices eased to USD 90.20 and 106.65/dmt. Most brands fell while SP10 edged higher, highlighting resource differences rather than a broad trend inferred from one product.

Inventory pressure is an important constraint. Ten-port stocks rose 3.2766 million mt WoW on Nov 12, with fines and lump contributing most of the increase. Latest surveyed daily hot metal rose 5,600 mt, but the improvement in consumption was modest. Earlier higher arrivals still require purchasing and port outbound volume to absorb them. Different samples and reporting periods mean the stock increase should not be attributed entirely to one factor.

A cautious, range-bound near-term view remains appropriate. Slightly higher hot metal and a steady domestic index provide some support, while weaker futures and spot prices, port stock accumulation and some higher transport costs constrain a rebound. Better mill orders and margins accompanied by sustained purchases could strengthen support; slow stock absorption and needs-based buying could leave ore prices fluctuating under pressure.

Today's Highlights

- **Futures and spot prices retreated.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **671.0 yuan/mt**, down 12.5 yuan (-1.83%) from Nov 11. Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 638 yuan/wmt, each down 8 yuan; Mac Fines fell 10 yuan to 641. All eight spot products declined.
- **Seaborne indices softened and most brand quotations fell.** The 61% index was **USD 90.20/dmt**, down 1.10 (-1.20%); the 65% was **106.65**, down 0.45 (-0.42%). Eleven brands fell USD 0.60–1.10/dmt against the Nov 11 report, while SP10 rose 0.25; moves were not uniform across products.
- **Port indices declined across grades.** The 61%, 58% and 65% indices were 649, 606 and 810 yuan/wmt, changing -4, -3 and -3 yuan; the 65%-58% spread remained 204 yuan. The seaborne 65%-61% spread widened from USD 15.80 to 16.45/dmt. Different market bases prevent direct comparison of absolute spreads.
- **Ten-port stocks built substantially.** Total inventory reached **107.9555 million mt** on Nov 12, up 3.2766 million mt (+3.13%) from Nov 5. Fines, concentrates and lump increased while pellets declined. Latest surveyed hot metal rose 5,600 mt WoW to 2.3629 million mt/day, but stock absorption still requires sustained purchasing.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	11-12 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	638	▼ -8 -1.24%	648	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	638	▼ -8 -1.24%	648	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	641	▼ -10 -1.54%	653	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	686	▼ -8 -1.15%	696	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	803	▼ -8 -0.99%	815	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	500	▼ -8 -1.57%	510	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	808	▼ -4 -0.49%	817	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	800	▼ -6 -0.74%	811	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	11-12 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	11-11
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.50	▼ -1.10 -1.26%	87.60
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.00	▼ -1.10 -1.25%	88.10
PB Fines 62% Daily	90.45	▼ -1.10 -1.20%	91.55
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	89.60	▼ -1.05 -1.16%	90.65
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	89.10	▼ -1.05 -1.16%	90.15
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	85.65	▼ -1.00 -1.15%	86.65
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	106.20	▼ -1.10 -1.03%	107.30
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	97.10	▼ -1.10 -1.12%	98.20
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	96.80	▼ -1.10 -1.12%	97.90
RTX Fines 61% Daily	87.20	▼ -0.60 -0.68%	87.80
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	88.60	▼ -1.05 -1.17%	89.65
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	79.60	▲ +0.25 +0.32%	79.35

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	91.19	+1.05%	-14.9%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	107.18	-1.06%	-12.1%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	654	-0.48%	-20.2%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	815	-0.32%	-9.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	608	-1.08%	-15.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	792.15	-1.66%	-10.6%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 90.20/dmt (-1.20%) and the 65% was 106.65 (-0.42%), widening their spread from USD 15.80 to 16.45/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 649, 606 and 810 yuan/wmt, changing -4, -3 and -3 yuan.

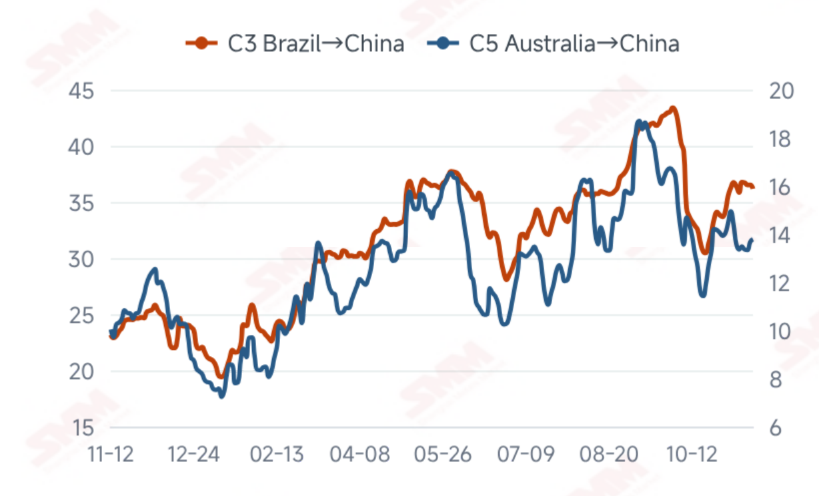
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

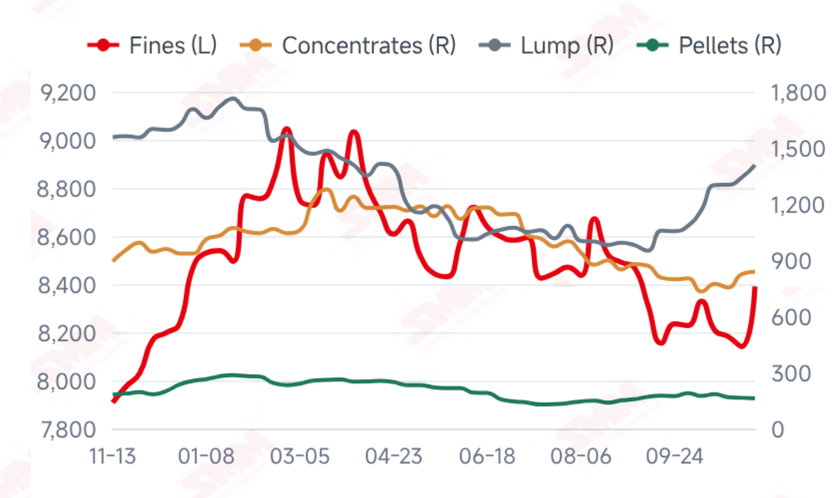
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



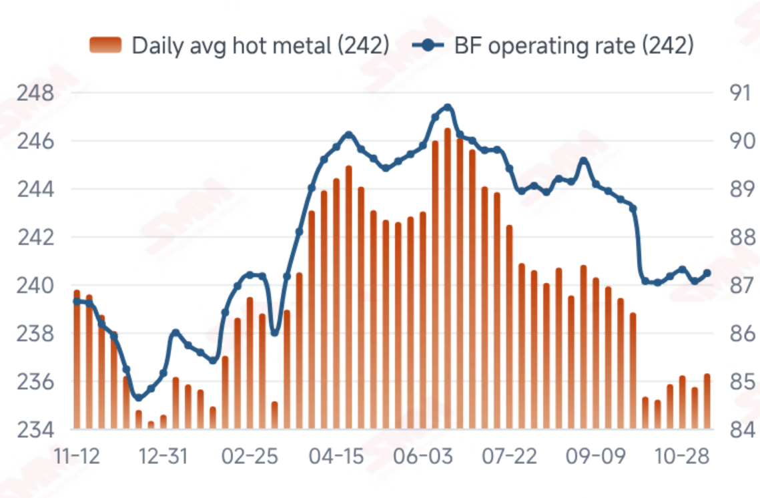
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



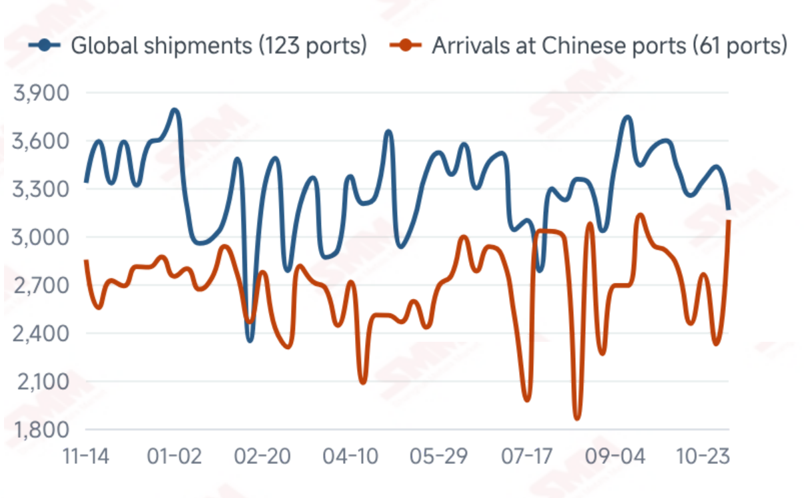
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot

DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 671.0 yuan/mt, down 12.5 yuan (-1.83%) from 683.5 on Nov 11. Qingdao PB Fines were 638, Newman Fines 638, BRBF 686, Newman Lump 803 and SSF 500 yuan/wmt, all down 8 yuan. Mac Fines fell 10 yuan to 641, Carajas Fines 4 yuan to 808 and PB Lump 6 yuan to 800. Joint futures and spot declines indicate pricing pressure, but do not directly quantify trading or procurement strength. SGX official current-month FEFX26 was last priced at USD 91.25/dmt, with quote time Nov 12, 17:38:33 and preparation time 17:56:32 (UTC+8).

Drivers

The seaborne 61% and 65% indices fell 1.20% and 0.42%, widening their grade spread; all three port grade indices declined. Most seaborne brands softened while SP10 rose, potentially reflecting resource quality, quotation timing or procurement composition. A single brand rebound does not establish broad demand improvement. USD dry-basis and RMB wet-basis prices differ in taxes and exchange-rate treatment and should not be translated directly into realizable arbitrage spreads.

Demand

Latest surveyed daily hot metal at 242 mills was 2.3629 million mt on Nov 11, up 5,600 mt (+0.24%) from Nov 4; the blast furnace operating rate rose 0.17 percentage point to 87.23%. Modestly improved consumption provides some support, but the limited gain is not enough to offset stock-building pressure. Better orders and margins accompanied by sustained buying could strengthen spot support; predominantly needs-based restocking could constrain a durable rebound.

Inventory & supply

Ten-port stocks were 107.9555 million mt on Nov 12, up 3.2766 million mt (+3.13%) from Nov 5. Fines were 83.9000 million mt (+2.4953 million mt), concentrates 8.3723 million mt (+136,900 mt), lump 14.0730 million mt (+674,900 mt) and pellets 1.6102 million mt (-30,500 mt). Fines and lump accounted for most of the total increase. In the latest week to Nov 6, global shipments fell 7.89% to 31.6051 million mt while Chinese arrivals rose 33.30% to 31.0133 million mt. Voyage lags and reporting periods differ; the latest stock build cannot be attributed entirely to a single supply or demand factor.

Cost & margin

Latest C3 freight was USD 36.16/mt on Nov 11, down 0.35 (-0.96%) from Nov 10; C5 rose 0.11 (+0.80%) to 13.78. Costs diverged across the two routes, with actual transmission depending on contracts and settlement timing. Lower seaborne and port prices may alter trading and steelmaking costs, but grades, exchange rates, taxes and inventory valuation require separate assessment; lower ore prices alone do not establish improved margins.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices

The Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 792.92 yuan/mt on Nov 12, unchanged from Nov 11. The national composite and regional concentrates differ in grade, wet/dry basis and taxes; absolute prices are not directly comparable, and an unchanged composite does not establish unchanged transaction prices in every region.

Supply & demand

The latest modest rebound in surveyed hot metal may offer some support to domestic ore consumption, while mine and beneficiation supply, regional transport and resource quality still create differences. Lower imported ore quotations may alter substitution choices at some mills, subject to grades and delivered costs. The composite alone does not establish nationwide tightness or sustained procurement improvement.

Outlook

Regional divergence may persist in the near term. Tight availability of good-quality resources accompanied by mill purchases could support local offers; limited improvement in orders and margins, with needs-based buying and price pressure from buyers, could restrain gains. Continued alignment between mine shipments and mill restocking remains important.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

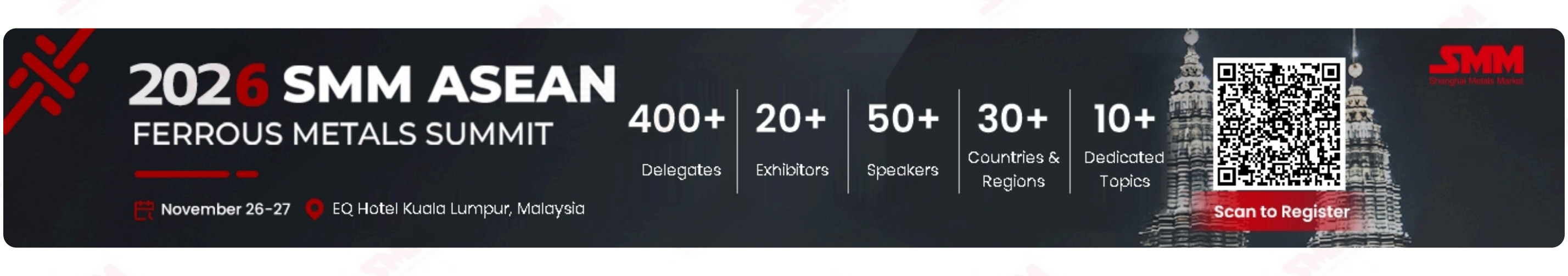
- Latest surveyed daily hot metal rose 5,600 mt WoW, modestly improving consumption.
- The blast furnace operating rate rose 0.17 percentage point to 87.23%.
- The Domestic Ore Composite Index held steady, indicating some price resilience.
- C3 freight fell 0.96%, potentially easing some Brazilian-route transport costs.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE fell 1.83% from the previous close and all eight port products declined.
- The seaborne 61% and 65% indices fell 1.20% and 0.42%.
- Ten-port stocks rose 3.2766 million mt WoW, with substantial fines and lump builds.
- Earlier higher arrivals still need absorption, while rising C5 freight adds some cost pressure.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Tighter output curbs and negative feedback weigh on iron ore ↗
  2026-11-12
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261112 ↗
  2026-11-12
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian Wire Rod Stays Firm at $500/tonne FOB Amid Gradual Demand Recovery; Mills Hold Prices Steady ↗
  2026-11-12
- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrate prices in west Liaoning may remain in the doldrums ↗
  2026-11-11
- [SMM Steel] EU HRC holds at highs as buyers resist mills' Q1 targets ↗
  2026-11-11
- [SMM Steel] Indian Domestic HRC Remains Stable as Europe-Bound Export Offers Firm ↗
  2026-11-11



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